

1. Title

Adherence to antihypertensive medication in older adults: a systematic review and meta-analysis.

2. Introduction

Adherence to antihypertensive medication declines with age, but the drivers of this decline are not well characterised.

This review asks which patient-level factors are most strongly associated with non-adherence in adults aged 65 and over.

3. Methods

Randomised and observational studies reporting medication adherence in adults aged 65+ prescribed antihypertensive treatment were eligible; studies without a validated adherence measure were excluded.

MEDLINE, EMBASE and CENTRAL were searched from inception to January 2025.

4. Results

Twelve studies (n = 4,812 participants) met the inclusion criteria and are summarised in Table 1.

Study	n
Smith 2019	412
Jones 2021	688

Table 1: Included studies.

5. Discussion

These findings are broadly consistent with prior reviews of medication adherence in older adults.